

Ethics and Consent

Ethical Principles

This study followed basic ethical principles for student research:

- Participation was voluntary.
- Participants understood the purpose of the study before consenting.
- Participants could stop at any time before submitting the form.
- The survey collected no direct personal identifiers.
- Results are reported in aggregate form.
- Raw data is shared only within the research team and with the instructor if required.

Consent Text Used in Google Forms

The following text appeared at the beginning of the questionnaire:

We are conducting a student research project for the Basic Research Methods and Tools course. The purpose of this survey is to understand how KIU undergraduate students perceive KIU's internship support services. The survey should take approximately 5–7 minutes. Participation is voluntary, and you may stop before submitting the form. Please do not include your name, student ID, email address, phone number, or other identifying information in open-ended responses. Your answers will be used only for academic purposes and reported in summary form.

Consent Question

Do you agree to participate in this survey?

Response options:

- Yes, I agree to participate.
- No, I do not agree to participate.

The form was configured so that respondents selecting "No" were routed directly to a final thank-you section and the form was submitted without collecting further data. All 122 analysed respondents selected "Yes."

Anonymity and Duplicate Prevention

Google Forms was configured to accept **only one response per account**. This served solely as a duplicate-prevention control at the point of collection: **no email address or other identifier was recorded in the exported data**. The exported CSV contains 26 columns, none of which identify a respondent.

Data Protection Plan

- The Google Forms response sheet is stored in a team-controlled Google Drive folder.
- The CSV is downloaded only when needed for analysis.
- No identifiable data is uploaded to public repositories.
- Because the project repository is public, it contains only anonymized data.
- Open-ended responses were checked for accidental names or contact details before reporting; none required removal.

Reporting Ethics

When writing results:

- Do not quote a response if it could identify a student.
- Combine similar open-ended comments into themes.
- Report small subgroups carefully (Mathematics $n = 12$; 2nd year $n = 18$).
- Avoid blaming individuals or offices; focus on service improvement.

Risks and Benefits

There were no expected major risks. Some questions asked for opinions about university support services, which respondents answered anonymously. The study may benefit the KIU community by identifying concrete ways to improve internship support.

Academic Integrity Note

Per the course guide, any use of AI tools to generate substantive content (written sections, analysis, literature synthesis, or interpretations) must be disclosed. The team is responsible for ensuring the intellectual content, analysis, and writing are its own, and for confirming with the instructor where the disclosure line sits for this course.